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USA CELEBRATES 250TH INDEPENDENCE ANNIVERSARY

Crowds enjoy a fireworks show from Brooklyn Bridge Park in the Brooklyn borough of New York, Saturday. A brief 'rubbish fire' broke out on Brooklyn Bridge during the annual Fourth of July fireworks display while a lightning strike was also seen hitting the bridge. But none of that could dampen the festive spirit as the country celebrated its 250th independence anniversary with a lot of fanfare.

SEE ALSO P10

New tenant credit screening service goes live in the UAE

Tenants' credit scores available through UAE PASS consent

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

UAE landlords can now request the credit scores of prospective tenants through Etihad Credit Bureau's (ECB) new Tenant Screening service, which has officially gone live after being announced earlier this year.

The service allows landlords to request a prospective tenant's credit score before entering into a tenancy agreement. The information is shared only

after the tenant provides consent through a verified UAE PASS account, making the process fully digital while allowing tenants to control whether their credit information is disclosed.

How it works

To initiate a request, landlords must select the Tenant Screening feature within the ECB app, enter the prospective tenant's Emirates ID details and complete payment. A secure consent request is then sent directly to the tenant through UAE PASS for approval. Once consent is granted, the tenant's credit score becomes available within the application. ECB said that "as soon as the tenant approves, the Credit Score appears directly in your app."

The service supports digital

payment methods, including Apple Pay and Google Pay, for landlords submitting screening requests.

ECB said tenants must have a fully verified UAE PASS profile before a screening request can proceed. If the tenant rejects the request or the consent request expires without approval, no credit information is shared with the landlord and the payment is refunded automatically.

The bureau said the service is intended to help landlords "gain deeper insights into applicant profiles and make more informed rental decisions." The screening process is available through the ECB application and relies on tenant approval before any credit score is disclosed.

SEE ALSO P-I

Nol upgrade moves Dubai closer to cashless transport

Next-generation Nol cards set for 2027 rollout

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

The Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) has completed 72 per cent of the biggest upgrade to the Nol card system since its launch in 2009, as Dubai moves closer to a cashless public transport network.

The new account-based ticketing platform will enable commuters to pay with QR codes, digital wallets, bank cards and next-generation nol cards when it is rolled out in early 2027, making travel across Dubai's public transport network faster, more flexible and more seamless.

The upgrade will replace the existing card-based ticketing system with a next-generation account-based ticketing (ABT)

platform. The project is being implemented in three phases.

The first will introduce QR-code ticketing through digital platforms, allowing passengers to purchase and validate tickets electronically.

The second phase will launch a new generation of Nol cards built on advanced global payment technologies. These cards will be digitally linked to customer accounts, making them easier to manage while ensuring compatibility with banking payment systems.

The final phase will enable commuters to pay directly using bank cards and digital wallets across Dubai's public transport network, reducing reliance on physical transit cards.

Under the upgraded system, customers will be able to create personal accounts, link multiple Nol cards including those of family members and manage balances from a single platform.

SEE ALSO P2

Trump's Iran 'one-shot' claim raises tensions

KHAMENEI'S THREE SONS PRESENT AT FUNERAL; MOJTABA NOT SEEN

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump's remark that Iran's senior leadership could be eliminated "in one shot" added to tensions as the funeral of former Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei continued.

In an interview with Axios, Trump said Washington had the capability to target Iran's remaining top officials but chose not to act in order to preserve the possibility of negotiations.

"They are all there. One shot, and we can take them all out. But we are not going to do that because then we would have nobody to negotiate with," he was quoted as saying.

'Fake tears'

Trump also expressed surprise at the scale of mourning in Iran, suggesting public reactions to Khamenei's death may not reflect earlier perceptions of his popularity. "I thought people hated Khamenei. Maybe it's fake tears," Trump said.

The remarks come as thousands continue to gather in Tehran for the state funeral, marked by mass processions, tight security and ceremonies scheduled across several cities before burial in Mashhad on July 9.

Three of Khamenei's sons attended the funeral, but Mojtaba Khamenei was notably absent.

Trump also expressed surprise at the scale of mourning in Iran, suggesting public reactions to Khamenei's death may not reflect earlier perceptions of his popularity.

Trump's comments come amid already strained US-Iran relations, which have remained volatile since the US-Israeli air strike that killed Khamenei on February 28.

Iran's army commander Amir Hatami told state TV he had vowed to Mojtaba Khamenei that he "will not let go of the collar of those who killed" the new leader's father.

The funeral emcee also launched a tirade against Trump during the ceremony, drawing loud reactions from the crowd.

Crowds of hundreds of thousands chanted "Death to America" and "Death to Israel," as they called for revenge over the February 28 attack.

A funeral procession is planned for today in Tehran, followed by similar events in the clerical hub of Qom tomorrow and in Iraq's holy cities of Najaf and Karbala on Wednesday, culminating in Khamenei's burial in his hometown of Mashhad in northeastern Iran on Thursday.

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